

The inventor of AutoCorrect is a stupid mass hole. He can fake right off.

I wanted to tell you a good time travel joke, but you didn't like it.

First LOL!

Laughter may be the best medicine, but where did it come from?

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Two hunters are out in the woods when one of them collapses. He doesn't seem to be breathing and his eyes are glazed. The other guy whips out his phone and calls emergency services. He gasps, "My friend is dead! What can I do?" The operator says, "Calm down sir. Let's make sure he's dead first." There is a short silence, then a gunshot is heard. The guy comes back on the line and says, "OK, now what?"

*What kind of murderer has fibre?
– A cereal killer.*

That second joke was made up by a computer, and the first one is considered to be the funniest joke in the world. This is according to a study done by psychologist Richard Wiseman in 2002. You can read more about it on the study's site – laughlab.co.uk.

Humour is something most of us are inherently capable of grasping. Of course tastes differ, so not all of us find the same things funny. In fact, even if we find the same joke funny, we may find it funny for different reasons. While we think that comedy is all about the comedian, it is actually all centered in our own heads – the

comedian merely gets us thinking, and our minds fill in the rest.

When it comes to this article, however, we're going to have to go much further back in time and look at much more than the origins of mere jokes... One way to understand the evolution of humour is to see if we humans have always had it. Of course fossils don't tell us anything about prehistoric humour, so we cannot get this information from our ancestors themselves. Instead, we need to look at our closest evolutionary cousins, and check them to see if they can understand and partake in humour.

Given that not all of us who speak the same language can agree on what's funny, what makes us so sure we can identify humour in other species, let alone partake in it? This was a challenge, obviously, but then we humans love a challenge almost as much as we love our jokes, right?

LAUGHING

There is no humour without laughter, and no comedian without an audience... in order for humour to prosper the way it has, it's obvious that there should be some evolutionary reason for laughing to feel good to people. Some scientists believe laughter actually far outdate humour itself, and go as far back as our fish ancestors to explain the act of laughing. For example, there's a theory by Dutch Biologist Jan Van Hooff that suggests that smiles might be equated to the baring of teeth

that many mammals display, and that laughter might actually stem from the 'relaxed open mouthed' that primates display when playing.

In a study done in 2009, it was found that the great apes do indeed "laugh" when tickled. The reason tickling was chosen is because the researchers didn't know any good ape jokes... (ok, I think we can all agree, that was a bad joke).

There are two types of tickling as well. The first is the light tickling that feels a little itchy and causes giggles, such as when you use a feather to rub against your skin, and the second is the harsh kind, which is like jabbing your fingers into someone's armpits or ribs, which usually causes laughter and screaming. The softer type is called knismesis, and is exhibited in many species, while the harder tickling is called gargalesis, and only humans, chimps, bonobos, gorillas and orangutans show the expected reaction to it.

We think that perhaps many species seem to respond to knismesis because it was evolutionarily advantageous to react to that feeling, which might have been caused by dangerous bugs or spiders crawling on the animals. The response would cause the animal to react and thus remove the cause of the knismesis, and thus prevent injury or poisoning.

Gargalesis, however, seems to be something a common ancestor of humans and the great apes developed, perhaps as a way of encouraging young ones to play with adults, or to practice and develop reflexes, perhaps. Of course there is no way to comprehensively prove why this trait developed, but given that humans and the great apes exhibit it, it's logical to assume that it developed before there were even homo sapiens, and thus the origins of ticklishness is truly ancient.

More recent studies have shown that rats too might feel ticklish (the gargalesis type), because studies have shown that when tickled hard in some spots on their bodies, rats emit high pitched squeals that research-